



WORKSHOP SESSION

THE REVERSE STARTUP PLAYBOOK

Build and scale globally from Nigeria before you even start.



Clinton Oyelami

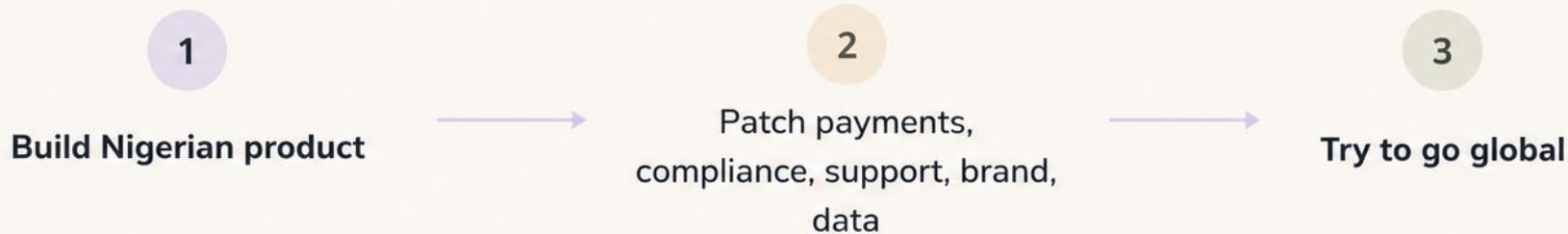
Cofounder Swerv & Travelbase

swervpay.co | travelbase.ai



The wrong default

Most founders build local first, then struggle to retrofit global later.



What usually breaks:



Pricing



Currency



Tax



Support



Regulation



KYC

Reverse the order

Start from the global outcome. Work backward to today's first move.

Traditional

Idea

MVP

Users

Revenue

Expansion



Reverse approach

Global customer

Revenue path

Rails + compliance

Lean MVP

First market

Before you build, answer five questions

These decisions save months of false motion.

- | | | |
|----|----------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| 01 | Who pays? | specific buyer + budget |
| 02 | Where first? | entry market + reason |
| 03 | What rail? | payment, logistics, data, compliance |
| 04 | What trust gap? | why should they believe you? |
| 05 | What breaks at 10x? | support, fraud, liquidity, infra |



Clarity before code.

The Musk-style build loop

Question -> delete -> simplify -> accelerate -> automate. In that order.



If you automate waste, you scale waste.

The founder's delete list

Deletion is not cost cutting. It's focus engineering.

Delete	Why
Extra features	They hide the core value.
Too many markets	They dilute learning.
Custom deals	They destroy repeatability.
Manual approvals	They slow the loop.
Vanity metrics	They create false confidence.

Nigeria is an edge, not a box

Use the operating pressure here as a global advantage.



Cost discipline

build lean by default



Talent density

ship with small teams



Chaos training

design for failure early



Currency lessons

think multi-market from day one



Distribution hustle

learn sales, not just ads



Do not build for the limitations. Build from the lessons.

Design for scale before scale arrives

Your first version should have the bones of a global company.



Scale is not a phase. It is an architecture.



Market

clear ICP + geography



Money

pricing, FX, settlement



Trust

brand, proof, support



Rules

legal, tax, data, compliance



Machine

ops, tooling, dashboards

Your 30–60–90 day plan

Leave with a clear execution rhythm.



30 days

Validate the global buyer

- 10 conversations
- 1 problem
- 1 paid signal



60 days

Build only the repeatable path

- rails
- compliance
- pricing
- MVP



90 days

Prove motion in one lane

- first revenue
- measured learning
- scale checklist

Build from Nigeria. Design for the world.

Reverse the journey. Delete the waste. Scale only what works.



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Q&A

